



Course-Level GenAI Policies: Why and How?

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Higher Education Act

Ch. 1, Sec. 4

The operations of higher education institutions shall be arranged to ensure that high standards are attained in courses and study programmes [...]

Ch. 1, Sec. 8:

[...] First-cycle courses and study programmes shall develop the ability of students to make independent and critical assessments, [...] to identify, formulate and solve problems autonomously [...]

BTH Assessment Rules

(new version in effect since 2026-05-01)

Sec. 4.1 Authorised Aids

[...] The use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) as support in summative assessments is permitted unless otherwise stated [...]

Examiners:

Your job is to assess these abilities.

You want some limitation of GenAI.

You need an explicit policy!

“academic integrity” ?

“never replace human judgment” ?

Template for Course-Level GenAI Policies

1. General Principles

Responsibility: Own every word, every line of code, every and idea.

Transparency: Be open about how you use GenAI, discuss it with your teachers.

2. Specific Guidelines

- How to understand concepts and related work
- How to write the thesis report
- How to deal with personal or confidential data
- How to write an opposition report

*Adjust to your
course-specific
activities and
learning
outcomes!*

3. Documentation & Consequences

- Mandatory disclosure of all AI use
- Oral Follow-Ups, Disciplinary Board



Template and policy examples (CC BY license)
<https://github.com/bth-dipt-teaching/genai-policy>

Example from Thesis Course PA2534

Guideline 2.1 Related Work & Conceptual Understanding

Do: Use AI-based search engines such as Scopus AI for initial literature discovery; use chat-based systems (e.g., ChatGPT) to discuss well-established concepts (e.g., “*explain the t-test to me*”).

Don't: Delegate judgment of paper credibility and relevance to AI; rely on AI summaries of papers; cite papers you haven't read yourself; cite papers that don't exist; use generated explanations in your writing.

Motivation: Scientific integrity requires citing identifiable, peer-reviewed sources. Assessing their quality is part of your thesis work.

Highlight
good and
bad uses

Connect to
learning
outcomes

Limitations

Policies do not magically change student behavior.

- Just yesterday: Hallucinated literature references *despite* one-page AI-declaration (got suspended until September)

Policies are the *start* of discussions, not the end.

- If your students start asking questions about the policy: It's a *good* sign.

Consequence: Engage with your students as much as possible! Meet them, talk to them, use *formative* assessments (i.e., immediate feedback mid-process).

Two Cautionary Tales:

Don't Assume You Know How Your Students Work

Using Copilot, posing as a student, asking about two topic ideas, *with the GenAI Policy attached*.



PA2534_Policy



DP_guidelines_4...



PA2534_syllabus

I am a master student working on my thesis project in software engineering. My next submission is a thesis plan. I have two topic ideas: [...] Which one should I go with?

⋮

If you want, next I can:

- help you **reframe either topic into examiner-friendly research questions**, or
- help you draft a **one-page “Introduction + Aim + RQs”** that would almost certainly pass review.

“I use Grammarly, for improving my language.”
– Show me!



grammarly



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GenAI Policies in Higher Education: Between Students' Utopia and Teacher's Hellscape

A Pedagogical Reflection

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1 Introduction

The popularization and wide-spread availability of Generative AI (GenAI) drives many changes in higher education – for better and worse. For students, these tools promise efficiency and infinite support; for teachers, they can lead to existential crisis about traditional assessment forms and academic integrity. However, much of the discourse is black and white, focussing on students cheating their way to a degree on the one side and grand opportunities to improve teaching and learning on the other, while ignoring a huge gray area with a variety of GenAI-induced behaviors and phenomena in the middle.

In this reflection I explore the non-trivial aspects of navigating, and enforcing responsible use of GenAI in learning.

2 Higher Education GenAI Policies

Writing a “good” GenAI policy is difficult because it requires balancing competing concerns of students, and administration. Orfanidis [1] surveyed 36 GenAI policies of HEIs in Canada, UK, and identified three dominant moral frameworks that represent different perspectives on GenAI.

1. The **Moral Consistency** perspective stands GenAI as disruption, as a danger to the integrity of higher education [1, Sec. 5.1]. Policies restrict or even reject GenAI in the course instructors have the ultimate authority, deciding what is wrong and right. In turn requires students to find a way in which AI is permitted for each course.
2. **Responsible Futureproofing** embraces GenAI and sees a moral imperative in having students use GenAI to prepare for life [1, Sec. 5.2].

Disciplinary Cases 2025 in Sweden

<i>Institution</i>	<i>Proportion</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Full-Time Students</i>
1. <i>Lunds universitet</i>	0.21%	64	30,802
2. <i>Chalmers tekniska högskola</i>	0.25%	29	11,727
3. <i>Uppsala universitet</i>	0.34%	102	29,743
⋮			
22. <i>Mittuniversitetet</i>	1.12%	95	8,450
23. <i>Högskolan Dalarna</i>	1.21%	83	6,884
24. <i>Blekinge tekniska högskola</i>	1.32%	39	2,950
25. <i>Högskolan i Halmstad</i>	1.35%	84	6,226
26. <i>Högskolan i Jönköping</i>	1.38%	118	8,536
27. <i>Högskolan Väst</i>	1.40%	79	5,640

Data:

<https://www.uka.se/download/18.7e8a0a5b19d8611740d5fb7/1776169186958/Disciplin%C3%A4renden%202025%20vid%20universitet%20och%20h%C3%B6gskolor.pdf>